Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 5 4 ♥ A K Q 2 ♦ A K Q J ♣ A K	
♠ J 10 9 8 ♥ J 10 9 8 ♦ 10 9 ♣ 10 6 5	N W E S	♠ 7 6 ♥ 7 6 ♦ 8 7 6 5 ♣ Q J 9 8 7
	♠ A Q 3 2 ♥ 5 4 3 ♦ 4 3 2 ♣ 4 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♦	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

7NT by North
Lead: ♣Q

Never mind the bidding. North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♣Q.

You have 12 top tricks. There are no finesses available, but a 3-3 split in either Major suit will provide the 13th trick. As you can see, this is not going to happen.

But there is another possibility; if the same defender holds 4 ♥s and 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him in those two suits.

You win the ♣K and play ♥ A K Q to test the ♥ suit, but East discards a ♣ on the ♥Q. (You tested ♥s first because of dummy's limited entries to the ♠ suit.)

Your ♥2 is not a winner but is a **THREAT** to become one. West holds the ♥J which is a **GUARD** against that happening.

Next play your 4 ♦ winners, discarding a ♣ from dummy. West follows twice, then starts to feel the pressure. He cannot discard the ♥J because it is guarding your ♥2, and since he can see those 4 ♠s in dummy he doesn't want to discard a ♠. He discards both his ♣s, trusting East to guard that suit.

Now you play the ♣A. At this point you are still hoping the ♠s will split 3-3. They aren't going to, as you see, but something wonderful happens instead. West cannot discard his ♥J because to do so would establish your ♥2. So he must throw a ♠ instead. You realize your ♥2 is not a winner so you just play ♠K, ♠A and ♠Q, and amazingly dummy's ♠3 has become your thirteenth trick.

Of course if West had discarded his ♥J you would have cashed your ♥2 and then taken three ♠ winners.

You just executed a Squeeze Play and you didn't even have to try.

This type of squeeze is called an ***automatic squeeze*** because it operates equally well against either defender. Suppose the EW hands were switched. Of course the opening lead would have been different, but when you were ready to play your ninth winner the hands would have looked like this.

This time it is East who holds the only Guards in both ♠s and ♥s.

You play the ♣A and he must give up one of those Guards.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 7 5 ♥ Q 8 6 3 ♦ Q 7 4 2 ♣ 6 4	
♠ 8 6 2 ♥ A K 10 2 ♦ J 10 9 3 ♣ 10 3	N W E S	♠ Q J 10 3 ♥ J 9 7 5 4 ♦ 8 6 ♣ 5 2
	♠ A K 4 ♥ — ♦ A K 5 ♣ A K Q J 9 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	7♣
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

7♣ by South
Lead: ♥K

South is to play 7♣. West leads the ♥K.

South is to play 7♣. West leads the ♥K.

You have 11 sure winners in your hand and dummy's ♦Q makes 12. Your main hope is for a 3-3 ♦ split in which case dummy's fourth ♦ will be a winner.

But there is another possibility in case the ♦s don't split. Dummy's ♥Q is a THREAT card which is GUARDED only by West's ♥A. If it is West who has the 4 ♦s you will be able to squeeze him.

You ruff the ♥K and play 5 more ♣ winners, being careful not to discard a ♦ or the ♥Q from dummy.

With everybody down to 7 cards this is the position. East's hand is important only in that he must hold on to his ♠ stopper. West must keep the ♥A and all four ♦s.

Play the ♠ A K and West begins to feel the heat.

On the ♠K you discarded dummy's small ♥ and West also discarded a ♥.

The ♣A is the SQUEEZE card. West absolutely cannot throw away his ♥A, so he discards a ♦ instead.

Since he still has the ♥A you know dummy's ♥Q is useless, so you discard it; East throws the ♥9. Dummy's fourth ♦ has become a winner.

This type of squeeze is called a ***positional squeeze*** because it only operates against one of the defenders. Suppose the EW hands were switched as shown below. When you were ready to play the Squeeze Card the hands would have looked like this.

East holds the only Guards in both red suits, but he cannot be squeezed.

You must play from dummy **BEFORE** East plays, so he just matches whatever you do.

If you discard the ♥Q East will throw his ♥A. If you discard dummy's fourth ♦, East will throw his fourth ♦.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q 8 4 ♥ A K J 6 ♦ K Q 7 2 ♣ 10 5	
♠ J 10 6 2 ♥ 8 4 ♦ J 9 8 4 ♣ 9 7 3		♠ 9 5 ♥ 10 7 5 2 ♦ 10 3 ♣ K Q J 4 2
	♠ A K 7 3 ♥ Q 9 3 ♦ A 6 5 ♣ A 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♣K

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♣K.

You have 11 winners, 3 ♠s, 4 ♥s, 3 ♦s and 1 ♣. If either ♠s or ♦s split 3-3 that would give you your 12th trick. If both split 3-3 you can make all thirteen tricks.

As you see, neither of them splits. However since one defender, West in this case, holds both Guards you should be able to squeeze him.

Visualize what would happen, though, if you win the first trick and then play your 4 ♥ winners. West would play his 3 ♣s and 2 ♥s on those 5 tricks and he would not be squeezed. The problem is that you have to **RECTIFY THE COUNT**.

To rectify the count you have to lose all the tricks you can afford to lose, which in this hand is exactly one trick. So you duck the ♣K and win the next trick when East continues with the ♣Q.

AHA! The count is rectified, so now you play your ♥ winners.

West has no problems on the first 3, he just plays his 2 ♥s and 1 ♣.

Here is the situation.

East follows.

The Squeeze Card is the ♥A.

You toss dummy's last small ♣ and West will have to decide whether it is better for him to throw a ♠ or a ♦. He doesn't know that discarding either one is going to hand you the contract, so he will probably discard a ♦.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 7 4 2 ♥ A K 3 ♦ A Q 7 4 ♣ K J 3	
♠ K Q 10 ♥ Q J 9 8 5 2 ♦ 10 3 ♣ 9 5	N W E S	♠ 9 8 6 5 ♥ 10 ♦ 9 8 5 2 ♣ 8 6 4 2
	♠ A J 3 ♥ 7 6 4 ♦ K J 6 ♣ A Q 10 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
2♥	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♠K

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♠K, dummy plays the ♠2 and East the ♠5.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 2 ♥s, 4 ♦s and 4 ♣s. If you can make a trick with the ♠J all will be well. But if not, as long as West holds the ♠Q, which is almost a certainty, you will be able to squeeze him in ♠s and ♥s.

The first thing you should do is to duck the ♠K. If West foolishly plays another ♠ your troubles are over. But he doesn't, he plays the ♥Q instead which you win with dummy's ♥K.

Even though West didn't play a second ♠ your first round duck served a very important purpose - it rectified the count for your squeeze.

Next play off your 4 ♦ winners, discarding a small ♥ from your hand.

You are now zeroing in on West.

Play the ♣K, ♣J, then over to your ♣Q.

Here is the layout after the 3 ♣ plays. Everybody followed suit except West who discarded a ♥ (unhappily, it seemed).

West discards the ♥9.

When you play your ♣A, discarding a ♠ from dummy, West is squeezed.

If he discards the ♠10, then his ♠Q will fall underneath your ♠A, establishing your ♠J.

But if he instead throws the ♥9, both of dummy's ♥s will become winners.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 7 5 2 ♥ A 10 8 ♦ A 9 3 ♣ A Q 8 2	
♠ J 9 4 3 ♥ 5 ♦ 8 6 5 2 ♣ J 10 9 4	N W E S	♠ 10 8 ♥ K Q J 9 6 3 ♦ 10 4 ♣ 7 6 3
	♠ A K Q 6 ♥ 7 4 2 ♦ K Q J 7 ♣ K 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	2♥	Dbl
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♥K

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♥K, dummy plays the ♥2 and West the ♥5.

As usual, you have 11 winners; 3 ♠s, 1 ♥, 4 ♦s and 3 ♣s. If ♠s split 3-3 dummy's ♠6 will become trick #12. If ♠s don't split though, you will have the chance of a squeeze if the defender with long ♠s also has 4 or more ♣s.

For a squeeze to operate you will need to lose one trick and the time to do that is right now. Let East hold the ♥K and win his ♥ continuation with your ♥A.

West discarded a ♦ on the second ♥.

You might as well find out about the ♠s right now. Play the ♠ A K Q.

Too bad, East discards a ♥ on the third round of ♠s.

West now holds the the only guard in ♠s.

Play the ♦A, then ♦ K Q.

West will follow to all three ♦s.

Now for the squeeze.

West discards.

Play dummy's ♦J and discard your last small ♥.

If West discards the ♠J you will cash dummy's ♠6, then win the last 3 ♣ tricks.

So West will no doubt throw a ♣ instead. In which case you win the last 4 ♣ tricks.

Squeezes are so very satisfying.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q 5 2 ♥ A 8 2 ♦ Q 8 6 4 ♣ K Q 2	
♠ K 10 7 3 ♥ K Q 10 6 ♦ 3 2 ♣ 10 9 5		♠ J 9 8 6 4 ♥ 9 5 3 ♦ 10 ♣ J 8 6 3
	♠ A ♥ J 7 4 ♦ A K J 9 7 5 ♣ A 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♦
Pass	5♦	Pass	6♦
All Pass			

6♦ by South
Lead: ♥K

South is to play 6♦. West leads the ♥K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 1 ♥, 6 ♦s and 3 ♣s.

At first things look hopeless, but remember this is a lesson on squeeze plays. From the opening lead you know that West must hold the ♥Q. If he also holds the ♠K you will be able to squeeze him in ♥s and ♠s.

You let the ♥K win, (hoping he will play another ♥), but he plays a small trump instead which you win in your hand.

Pull one more round of trumps, then unblock the ♠A.

Then take your 3 ♣ winners, ending in your hand.

Now play ♦Q, ♦J, ♦9. Discard the ♠5 from dummy on the third ♦.

West could afford to throw 2 ♠s and a ♥ on your ♦ plays.

West discards the ♥10.

When you play the ♦7 he is squeezed.

He cannot dump his ♠K because you would throw the ♥8 and dummy would be high.

So he will discard the ♥10 instead. At this point you know that the ♠Q is worthless so you discard it. You win the final two tricks with the ♥A and ♥J.

Board 7
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 8 7 ♥ A Q 9 8 6 2 ♦ Q 7 ♣ 7 5 2	
♠ Q 10 9 3 ♥ 10 5 4 ♦ K J 10 ♣ A K Q	N W E S	♠ 6 5 4 2 ♥ J ♦ 9 8 4 3 ♣ J 10 9 3
	♠ A K J ♥ K 7 3 ♦ A 6 5 2 ♣ 8 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♣J

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♣J. West wins ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

West takes ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

West opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and East has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with West and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already rectified.

You plan to squeeze West by running the long ♥s in your hand.

The ♦Q was not a Threat card yet: to make it a Threat you had to unblock dummy's ♦A. Then you pull trumps with the ♥ A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to West.

Play the ♥ 9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. West is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

West is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

East discards.

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

West can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not West.

If you discard the ♦6 West will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, West will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

Board 8
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 2 ♥ 9 3 ♦ A K 8 6 ♣ K Q 10 6 5	
♠ J 10 6 5 ♥ K Q J 7 5 ♦ 9 2 ♣ 8 4		♠ K 9 8 4 3 ♥ 10 8 6 2 ♦ J 10 7 3 ♣ —
	♠ Q 7 ♥ A 4 ♦ Q 5 4 ♣ A J 9 7 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♣
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♣
All Pass			

6♣ by South
Lead: ♥K

♠Q is the Vienna Coup.

West discards.

South is to play 6♣. West leads the ♥K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦s also holds the ♠K and that a squeeze will be possible.

You win the first trick and pull trumps in two rounds, ending in dummy.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you rectify the count by giving up a ♥.

West takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦9 which you win with your ♦Q.

West plays low.

The key play: taking dummy's ♠A before running three rounds of ♣s.

Unblocking the ♠A to create a Threat out of your

East was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣7 and discard dummy's ♠2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥K.

Board 9
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 4 3 ♥ A K Q J ♦ A K ♣ A K Q 5 2	
♠ J 10 8 6 ♥ 9 7 ♦ 10 8 3 ♣ J 9 8 4		♠ 9 ♥ 10 5 3 2 ♦ Q J 9 6 4 2 ♣ 10 7
	♠ A K Q 7 5 2 ♥ 8 6 4 ♦ 7 5 ♣ 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

7NT by North
Lead: ♦Q

West follows twice, then discards 2 ♦s.

Don't play ♠s yet!

Play your ♦A. West must give up.

If he throws the ♣J, you win. But if he throws a ♠ you also win. This is what is called a Win-Win bridge play.

South's 3NT rebid shows 6 ♠s headed by A K Q and nothing else. North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♦Q.

Nice hand. You have 12 high card tricks and either a 3-2 ♠ split or a 3-3 ♣ split will land this Grand Slam. But even if neither suit splits nicely you can STILL make it if the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits; in that case you will squeeze for the thirteenth trick.

You win the ♦K.

Win the ♦K and (**IMPORTANT!**) test the ♣s first by playing ♣ A K Q. Darn. East discards a ♦ on the ♣Q.

Alright, so West holds the ♣ Guard. You still need to exercise caution.

Play your 4 ♥ winner's next. East follows suit while

Board 10
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ 10 6 ♥ A K 8 6 ♦ 9 7 3 ♣ A K Q J	
♠ 8 5 3 ♥ Q 10 7 2 ♦ J 10 8 4 ♣ 6 3		♠ 9 7 4 2 ♥ J 4 ♦ A 6 5 2 ♣ 9 5 2
	♠ A K Q J ♥ 9 5 3 ♦ K Q ♣ 10 8 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♦J

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♦J. East takes the ♦A and returns the ♦2.

Your 4 ♠ tricks, 2 ♥ tricks, 1 ♦ trick and 4 ♣ tricks are very easy to find. But that's only 11, so where in the world can you possibly find number 12?

With all those high ♦s falling on the first two tricks dummy's ♦ 9 has become a threat against West. If it should happen that West also holds the only ♥ stopper you can squeeze him in the red suits.

You are going to run your black suit winners, taking the ♣s first so you can be playing winners from your hand when you squeeze West.

On the last 2 ♣s West discards a ♦ and a ♥.

Now come to your hand with the ♠A and play the ♠ K Q.

You discard a small ♥ from dummy while West follows suit three times.

It is time.

West discards the ♥7, holding on to the ♦10.

Play your ♠J and watch what West discards.

If he holds on to the ♦10 you will discard dummy's useless ♦9 and hope the ♥s all fall under the ♥ A K.

If he discards the ♦10 then you throw dummy's small ♥ and dummy wins the last three tricks.

Board 11
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 3 ♥ K Q ♦ A K Q J 9 3 ♣ Q 8 3	
♠ J 10 8 6 ♥ A 8 4 2 ♦ 5 ♣ K 9 4 2	N W E S	♠ 7 4 2 ♥ J 10 9 6 3 ♦ 8 6 4 ♣ J 6
	♠ A K Q 5 ♥ 7 5 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ A 10 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6NT by North
Lead: ♥J

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♥J. West wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

East plays low.

The solution is the Vienna Coup: a ♣ to the ♣A at trick 3.

Then start running the ♦ suit.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

East discards.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

West is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

Board 12
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 3 ♥ K 9 8 6 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ A K Q 5	
♠ Q J 10 6 4 ♥ 10 ♦ 10 9 7 4 2 ♣ 8 2		♠ A 8 5 2 ♥ 4 ♦ K Q 8 3 ♣ J 10 9 3
	♠ K 7 ♥ A Q J 7 5 2 ♦ J 5 ♣ 7 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

Play 5 ♥ winners and the ♠K.

Drum roll please.

West discards.

Play your ♥2 and dump dummy's ♦6.

East has no answer.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. East wins the ♠A and plays the ♦K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

East's ♦K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦Q also, so your ♦J is now a Threat against East. If he holds 4 ♣s you can squeeze him.

Board 13
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K Q 7 3 ♥ A 4 ♦ Q 9 6 2 ♣ A 8 4	
♠ J 10 9 6 4 ♥ 9 8 3 2 ♦ — ♣ Q 10 6 3	N W E S	♠ 8 ♥ K Q 10 7 5 ♦ 10 8 4 ♣ J 9 5 2
	♠ A 5 2 ♥ J 6 ♦ A K J 7 5 3 ♣ K 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

7NT by North
Lead: ♥K

North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♥K, dummy plays the ♥6 and West the ♥2.

With 12 obvious tricks your first thought should be that perhaps the ♠s will split 3-3.

Then, your second thought should be that dummy's ♥J is a Threat against East's ♥Q, so if it is East who holds 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him.

Since the contract is 7NT you take the first trick with the ♥A.

With one trick in the bag you should test ♦s next. When you play the ♦A West discards a ♠.

You continue with the ♦Q and ♦ K, West discarding a ♥ and a ♣.

Since West has shown up with a ♦ void he has become the odds-on favorite to hold the ♠ Guard. His ♠ discard makes it very likely that he started with 5 ♠s.

To find out for sure you play ♠A, then ♠Q. Sure enough East discards a ♥ on the second round.

You can't squeeze East in ♥s and ♠s because he doesn't hold the ♠ Guard, West does.

But now a completely new possibility shows up. Say to yourself, over and over, "East must guard ♥s, and West must guard ♠s. Nobody can guard ♣s."

You start playing dummy's ♦ winners.

With one more ♦ in dummy, things look like this.

West discards the ♣6.

When you play the ♦5 West must keep both ♠s to guard against your ♠7. So he discards the ♣6, hoping partner can stop that suit.

Your ♠7 is now worthless so you throw it.

East has no problem, (yet), he discards the ♥10.

It is now time to pressure East.

Play dummy's ♠5 to your ♠K.

East MUST keep his ♥Q so he releases his ♣5.

And you win the last three tricks with ♣K, ♣A, ♣8.

This is called a Double Squeeze.

Board 14
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 5 2
♥ 6
♦ A J 9 7 4
♣ Q 8 4 3

♠ Q J 10 8 3
♥ J 10 7 2
♦ 6 3
♣ 10 6



♠ 6
♥ Q 9 8 4 3
♦ 8 5 2
♣ J 9 7 5

♠ A K 7 4
♥ A K 5
♦ K Q 10
♣ A K 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	3♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

7NT by South
Lead: ♠Q

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♠Q.

One more winner is needed. Dummy's fourth ♣ is a possibility.

So take the ♠K and play ♣ A K Q.

West discards a ♠ on the third ♣.

Now you know East guards the ♣s.

Before tackling ♦s, see what you can discover about ♠s.

Play the ♠A. East discards a ♥.

East guards the ♣s. West guards the ♠s. Nobody can guard the ♥s.

Play 4 rounds of ♦s.

On the fourth ♦ East had to discard a ♥. You discarded a small ♠. West discarded a ♠ on the third ♦ and a ♥ on the fourth.

East discards a ♥.

You play dummy's ♦4. East cannot throw the ♣J or he will set up dummy's ♣8, so he discards a ♥.

You discard the ♠7.

Now West is squeezed. He cannot discard the ♠J or he will set up dummy's ♠9, so he discards a ♥.

You win the last three ♥ tricks with another Double Squeeze.

Board 15
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 5 ♥ A K J 9 8 3 ♦ A 5 ♣ K 8 6 3	
♠ Q 6 2 ♥ 7 5 2 ♦ J 9 8 4 3 ♣ J 4		♠ A K J 9 4 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ Q 10 2
	♠ 10 8 7 3 ♥ Q 10 ♦ K Q 6 ♣ A 9 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	1♠	2♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠A

from your hand.

Then lead dummy's ♣7 to your ♣K.

Here you are in your hand.

Only East can guard dummy's ♠10, and only East can guard dummy's♣9.

East discards the ♣10, holding on to the ♠J.

You play your ♥A and East must give up one of his guards. If he holds on to the ♠J then you toss dummy's useless ♠10. If he throws the ♠J then you toss dummy's ♣9.

North is to play 6♥. East leads the ♠A, then ♠K.

When you looked at just your and dummy's cards on the previous page it may have looked impossible to find a twelfth winner.

Even looking at all four hands here it is still very difficult to come up with a plan.

Here's a hint: If East holds 3 ♣s, (and you see that he does), can you squeeze him in ♣s and ♠s?

Of course you ruffed the ♠K.

The big problem with trying to squeeze East in the black suits right now is that West actually holds a ♠ guard. But you can fix that.

You draw two rounds of trumps with dummy's ♥Q and ♥10.

West plays the ♠Q and you ruff. Then you pull the last trump.

Now play the ♦A, ♦K, and ♦Q, discarding the ♣3

Board 16
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q 10 ♥ K Q 5 3 ♦ A 8 6 3 ♣ 8 5 2	
♠ A K 9 3 2 ♥ 10 4 2 ♦ J 9 ♣ J 6 4	N W E S	♠ 8 6 5 ♥ J 9 8 6 ♦ Q 10 4 ♣ Q 10 9
	♠ J 7 4 ♥ A 7 ♦ K 7 5 2 ♣ A K 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♠3

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠3. East plays the ♠5.

From the opening lead of ♠3 and East's play of ♠5 you should have deduced that West held five ♠s to the A K. Therefore if you lose a trick in any other suit West will be able to take 4 ♠ tricks and defeat you.

You have 8 winners, and if East holds 4+ ♥s AND 3+ ♦s then only he can guard the two suits.

But how can you squeeze him?

Dummy's ♠10 won the first trick.

The answer to that question is that **YOU** cannot squeeze him.

But maybe you can make his partner do the job for you.

At trick 2 you play a ♠.

Of course West will win this with his ♠K.

And he will no doubt continue with the ♠A and ♠9.

West continues with the ♠A and the ♠9; dummy discards two ♦s.

You discard 2 ♦s from dummy and a ♣ from your hand.

East cannot spare either a ♥ or a ♦ so he also throws a ♣.

Remember this position

West will almost surely cash his ♠2.

West cashes the ♠2; dummy discards a ♣ and East the ♣Q.

You and dummy both discard a ♣ and East also must discard a ♣.

It doesn't matter what West plays next, lets say it is a ♣.

You are in your hand with the ♣K.

You play the ♣A.

East is truly squeezed. If he discards a ♥, dummy's ♥5 will become a winner. but if he discards a ♦ then you will get a third ♦ trick and the contract.

Since it was West who started the squeeze by cashing his last ♠, this is called a Suicide Squeeze.**BUT**, what if West had not cashed that ♠?

Board 17
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A ♥ A 6 3 ♦ K 5 ♣ A K Q J 9 8 7	
♠ 10 7 5 4 2 ♥ J 10 2 ♦ Q 10 4 3 ♣ 4		♠ K Q 9 6 3 ♥ Q 9 8 5 ♦ 9 ♣ 10 6 2
	♠ J 8 ♥ K 7 4 ♦ A J 8 7 6 2 ♣ 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	3♦
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	6♦[4]
Pass	7♣		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace
3. asks for kings
4. 1 king

7♣ by North
Lead: ♠K

North is to play 7♣. East leads the ♠K.

At first glance this doesn't appear to be a difficult hand. You expect to win the opening lead, pull trumps, then establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦K, ♦A, and ruffing a ♦. As long as they split 3-2 you could reach dummy's ♦ winner with the ♥K.

So you take the ♠A, pull three rounds of trumps and play ♦K.

But when you lead to the ♦A East discards a small ♠.

Time to rethink. You are in dummy now, and you can ruff a ♦, return with the ♥K and ruff another ♦. The last ♦ would be good but you'd have no way to reach it.

Think squeeze instead.

You ruff a ♦. This turns the ♦J into a Threat card against West's ♦Q.

But, the ♠J is already a Threat card against East's ♠Q.

You play your ♣J.

Play your ♣J and ♣9, discarding the ♦8 and the ♥4 from dummy.

East can afford to discard the ♠9 and the ♥5.

West can spare his two ♠s.

You are there.

East gives up the ♥8.

Your ♣8 does it.

East cannot throw the ♠Q, so he gives up the ♥8. Dummy's ♠J is of no further value so you dump it.

West cannot throw the ♦Q, so he gives up the ♥2.

And you take the last three tricks with the ♥ suit. There were only two defenders; one of them had to guard ♠s and the other had to guard ♦s. There was nobody left to guard ♥s.

Board 18
South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 4
♥ J 9 7 3
♦ K 7 5
♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ A K J 8 6 5 3 2
♥ 8 6 2
♦ 10
♣ 7

N
W E
S

♠ 10 9 7
♥ 4
♦ Q J 9 4 2
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ —
♥ A K Q 10 5
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ A K Q 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
4♠	Pass	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠A

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠A.

If ♦s and ♣s split nicely this would be an easy slam. But with that wild ♠ bid by West you can't expect decent splits.

So you ruff the ♠, pull trumps in three rounds, then play ♣ A K and get the bad news when West discards a ♠.

You now know that East guards the ♣s. And since West had 3 ♥s and a very long ♠ suit it is pretty likely that East guards the ♦s also. You will try to squeeze East in ♣s and ♦s, but first you must lose a trick to rectify the count.

West plays the ♦10.

So you play a low ♦ from each hand.

It doesn't matter which defender takes the ♦, since either one is going to do the same thing. Assume West wins the ♦10.

He will then play the ♠K, which you must ruff in your hand.

West discards.

A small ♦ to dummy's ♦K.

You are in dummy, ready for the squeeze.

You play dummy's ♥J.

East gets to choose his own fate - discarding a protector in one of the two suits. Of course, whichever suit he discards you will throw the opposite one.

Yet another slam, courtesy of the Squeeze Play!

Board 19
East Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ — ♥ A K Q J 9 5 ♦ J 6 3 ♣ A K J 6	
♠ J 8 5 2 ♥ 8 7 2 ♦ 9 4 ♣ 10 8 4 2	N W E S	♠ A Q 9 7 6 3 ♥ 3 ♦ K Q 10 2 ♣ 9 7
	♠ K 10 4 ♥ 10 6 4 ♦ A 8 7 5 ♣ Q 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
Pass	Dbl	2♦	2NT
Pass	4♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by North
Lead: ♦K

North is to play 6♥. East leads the ♦K. Perhaps you wouldn't have bid slam with South's cards, but he has been watching you pull off some fantastic squeeze plays and he has every confidence you will do it again.

You know East also has the ♦Q, so your ♦J will be a Threat card against him.

And you are 99.9% sure he also has the ♠A, so dummy's ♠K will also be a Threat card against him.

You should be able to squeeze him in the two suits. What is your first act?

Your first act should be to rectify the count. And the safest way to do that is to just let East hold the first trick. Who knows, he might be foolish enough to play another ♦, or even to lead the ♠A. Defenders do make mistakes sometimes.

But not this defender, not this time.

He exits with the ♥3 which you take with your ♥Q.

Pull two more rounds of trumps, then run four ♣s, ending in your hand.

You throw a ♠ from dummy and East discards ♠s and ♦s.

You are closing in. Play the ♥J, then the ♥9.

Discard the ♠10 and ♦7 from dummy.

East discards the ♠Q and ♠9.

East bares his ♦Q.

At last you play the ♥5, and East is done, he just doesn't know it yet.

He obviously is not going to throw his ♠A and make dummy high, so he will instead bare his ♦Q.

So you dump dummy's ♠K and win the last two tricks with the ♦A and then the ♦J.

Board 20
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ 10 9 5 ♥ 7 5 ♦ A Q 10 7 2 ♣ A J 4	
♠ 6 ♥ A 6 3 ♦ 6 5 4 ♣ 9 8 7 5 3 2	N W E S	♠ A 3 ♥ K 9 8 4 2 ♦ K 9 8 ♣ K 10 6
	♠ K Q J 8 7 4 2 ♥ Q J 10 ♦ J 3 ♣ Q	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥A

North's 2♥ cue-bid shows ♠ support and at least a limit-raise or better. South is to play 4♠. West leads the ♥A, then a ♥ to East's ♥K. East plays a third round of ♥s.

You were expecting to see all four hands, not just North/South again. The reason you are seeing it like this is that you must do some deducing first.

You saw the bidding and you know that West started with the ♥A and East started with the ♥K.

Before you can make a good Plan you need to figure out where the ♠A, ♦K and ♣K are located.

The three unaccounted for honors have a value of 10 points and every one of them must be in East's hand. With the ♥K he still needs those points to have enough strength to open the bidding. So you can forget about either finesse working.

Now on with the plan. East/West took the first two ♥ tricks and then played a third ♥ which you won, discarding the ♦2 from dummy.

You need to pull trumps so you play your ♠K. East wins with his ♠A and returns the ♠3 to your ♠Q.**

This pulls all the trumps and also serves to rectify the count for your upcoming squeeze.

**By the way, notice that if East had played any other way he would have handed you the contract.

You plan to squeeze East in ♦s and ♣s. But if you start running your trumps now you will have a problem with dummy's discards. You will come down to the ♦ A Q and the ♣ A J and will have to discard one of them BEFORE East has to discard.

So dummy's ♦Q cannot be one of the Threat cards. Instead you must make the ♦J in YOUR hand a Threat.

West plays low.

You play the ♦A immediately, a Vienna Coup.

Now that you have your Threats properly positioned you can get on with the squeeze.

Overtake dummy's ♠10 and run three more ♠s.

Discard all three ♦s from dummy.

East will discard his 2 ♥s, the ♦9 and the ♣6.

And now the moment you have been waiting for all these 20 Deals.

West discards.

Play your ♠2 and discard dummy's ♣4.